

Clay particles look like tiny, flat plates.

Clay

Sand

Silt

Sizing it up

Soil particles come in different sizes. Imagine a clay particle as a large coin. Next to it, silt would be as big as a tennis ball, and coarse sand the size of a hot-air balloon!

Sand particles look like very small rock pieces.



The best soil for plants has not too much sand or clay.

Plant Food

Soil is made up of sand, silt, and clay particles. The amount of each affects how fertile soil is, how much water it holds, and how well water drains through it.

It can take eight years for soil as thick as card to form.

Gold

Garnet

Sandstone

Citrine

Both plants and animals can become fossils.

Fossils are the traces (such as footprints) or remains in rocks of living things from millions of years ago.